

Chapter 4

Getting Help in Red Hat Enterprise Linux

Reading Manual Pages (**man**)

One source of documentation that is generally available on the local system are system manual pages or man pages. These pages are shipped as part of the software packages for which they provide documentation, and can be accessed from the command line by using the man command.

```
[root@localhost ~]# man date
```

```
DATE(1)                                User Commands                                DATE(1)

NAME
    date - print or set the system date and time

SYNOPSIS
    date [OPTION]... [+FORMAT]
    date [-u|--utc|--universal] [MMDDhhmm[[CC]YY][.ss]]

DESCRIPTION
    Display the current time in the given FORMAT, or set the system date.

    Mandatory arguments to long options are mandatory for short options too.

    -d, --date=STRING
        display time described by STRING, not 'now'

    --debug
        annotate the parsed date, and warn about questionable usage to stderr

    -f, --file=DATEFILE
        like --date; once for each line of DATEFILE

    -I[FMT], --iso-8601[=FMT]
        output date/time in ISO 8601 format.  FMT='date' for date only (the default), 'hours', 'minutes', 'seconds', or 'ns'
        for date and time to the indicated precision.  Example: 2006-08-14T02:34:56-06:00

Manual page date(1) line 1 (press h for help or q to quit)
```

Heading	Description
NAME	Subject name. Usually a command or file name. Very brief description.
SYNOPSIS	Summary of the command syntax.
DESCRIPTION	In-depth description to provide a basic understanding of the topic.
OPTIONS	Explanation of the command execution options.
EXAMPLES	Examples of how to use the command, function, or file.
FILES	A list of files and directories related to the man page.
SEE ALSO	Related information, normally other man page topics.
BUGS	Known bugs in the software.
AUTHOR	Information about who has contributed to the development of the topic.

Reading Info Documentation (**pinfo**)

To launch the Info document viewer, use the pinfo command.

```
[root@localhost ~]# pinfo
```

```
File: dir,      Node: Top      This is the top of the INFO tree

This (the Directory node) gives a menu of major topics.
Typing "q" exits, "H" lists all Info commands, "d" returns here,
"h" gives a primer for first-timers,
"mEmacs<Return>" visits the Emacs manual, etc.

In Emacs, you can click mouse button 2 on a menu item or cross reference
to select it.

* Menu:

Archiving
* Cpio: (cpio).      Copy-in-copy-out archiver to tape or disk.
* Tar: (tar).        Making tape (or disk) archives.

Basics
* Bash: (bash).      The GNU Bourne-Again SHell.
* Common options: (coreutils)Common options.
* Coreutils: (coreutils).  Core GNU (file, text, shell) utilities.
* Date input formats: (coreutils)Date input formats.
* Ed: (ed).          The GNU line editor
* File permissions: (coreutils)File permissions.
                        Access modes.
* Finding files: (find).  Operating on files matching certain criteria.
* Time: (time).        GNU time utility.

Viewing line 26/318, 8%
```